KENYA UNIVERSITY MATATU & STUDENT RENTAL TRANSPORT RESEARCH

Route leads • campus access • rental areas • 50 km study radius • field verification system

Research edition: 10 October 2026

A 100+ page working research report for 23 university/campus study areas, with copyable route leads and structured fieldwork forms.

Important scope note

This report is a route research atlas, not a complete census of every individual matatu vehicle in Kenya. Public route directories and university sources can establish route leads, campus locations and some stages. They do not provide a complete, real-time count of all vehicles, all fares, every intermediate stop or every operating hour. Unknown details are explicitly marked for field verification instead of being invented.

Prepared as a research and data-collection workbook. Verify routes, fares, safety and accommodation before making travel or housing decisions.

Contents and navigation

- Part A — Executive summary, scope, definitions and data-quality rules
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- Part D — 23 university/campus profiles, each with four operational pages
- Part E — Field observation forms for vehicle counts, stages, fares, rental areas and transfers
- Part F — Data dictionary, quality controls, privacy and safety
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- Appendices — blank forms for repeated fieldwork and follow-up checks

How to use this report

Treat each campus profile as a hypothesis to test. First verify the exact campus gate and student origin area. Then visit the relevant stage, record displayed destinations and operator/SACCO, count departures during a stated observation window, and interview more than one source. Keep route-level facts separate from vehicle-level observations. When data conflict, retain both observations with dates and sources rather than silently selecting one.

Status labels used in the report

Status	Meaning
Published route lead	A route number/corridor appears in a public route guide; current operation and exact stages still require confirmation.
Official campus context	Institutional page or student document supports campus, accommodation or transport context.
Field verification required	No sufficiently reliable public source in this research establishes the exact detail.
Observed field value	A value to be filled only after a dated field observation or documented interview.
Historical fare	A past study or old listing reported a fare; do not treat it as today's fare.

Executive summary

The study focuses on student journeys between university campuses, urban transport hubs, off-campus rental areas and nearby towns within approximately 50 km. It covers 23 university/campus study areas, including the six requested institutions—UoN, KU, JKUAT, Maseno, Egerton and Kirinyaga—plus other major universities and technical institutions. Daystar's Athi River campus is treated as a distinct transport market from its Nairobi campus.

Strongest publicly documented route leads in the current research

- Nairobi–Thika corridor: Route 237 is described in a public route guide as serving Nairobi CBD, Ruaraka, Roysambu, Githurai, Kahawa, the KU corridor, Ruiru, Kimbo, Juja, the JKUAT area and Thika. Each actual vehicle's stopping pattern still needs confirmation.
- Nairobi–Ruiru corridor: Routes 145 and 146 are listed in a Nairobi route directory, with differing corridor descriptions and stops.
- Nairobi–Parklands corridor: Routes 11A and 11B are listed via Ngara/Forest Road; route 11F serves the Parklands–Ruaka corridor.
- Strathmore/Madaraka: Route 14A is a published corridor lead for CBD–Madaraka/Strathmore.
- Daystar Athi River: Route directory lists 110/110A on the Mombasa Road/Mlolongo/Athi River corridor, but this does not prove a direct campus-gate service.
- Egerton: A Nakuru route-directory lead identifies the CBD/KFA–Njoro/Egerton corridor as NK6; confirm current operation and operator.
- Moi Main Campus: student travel guidance identifies Eldoret Main Stage/Uganda Road as a departure point for Main Campus, distinguishing it from the Annex route.
- University of Eldoret: a 2025 transport-cost assessment sampled Junction, Mti Moja and Kuinet journeys to Gate A and referenced CHEP SACCO; fares need updating.
- Maseno and Kirinyaga: official university/accommodation context provides useful starting points, but many local stage and route details still require fieldwork.

Main limitation

No public source located in this research provides an exhaustive, real-time inventory of all matatus by registration number, route, shift, operator, fares and every intermediate stage for all the campuses. The report therefore includes structured forms for counting vehicles and validating routes instead of manufacturing vehicle totals.

Research questions and boundaries

Core questions

- Which matatu routes and operators connect each university to nearby rental clusters and surrounding urban centres?
- Where do vehicles board and alight in each direction, and which services actually reach a campus gate or require a transfer?
- Which areas are within approximately 50 km of each campus by road, and which are practical daily commuting origins?
- What are the current stage-to-stage fares, departure windows, wait times and evening/weekend service patterns?
- How many departures are observed during defined time windows, and how can those observations be distinguished from total fleet size?
- Which off-campus accommodation clusters are close to verified stages and safe walking routes?

Geographic rule

The phrase 'within 50 km' is ambiguous unless measured consistently. For this project, use road distance from the selected campus gate as the operational measure for commuting. Keep straight-line distance in a separate field if available. Mark places outside 50 km by road as 'beyond-radius comparison' rather than silently including them in the core radius.

What is not assumed

- No assumed current fare where the source is historical, vague or absent.
- No assumed number of operating vehicles based only on a route directory.
- No assumption that a highway matatu stops at a university gate.
- No assumption that a university shuttle is open to all passengers.
- No assumption that a nearby town has reliable return service at night.
- No claim that a named rental area currently has vacant, affordable or safe accommodation.

Research methodology: public-source review

Phase 1: Desk research

- Review official university pages for campus addresses, official shuttle information, accommodation notices and student travel instructions.
- Review route directories for route number, broad corridor, published termini and possible intermediate stops.
- Review accommodation pages and listings to establish residential areas worth surveying, not to certify current availability or quality.
- Record the URL, publication/update date if known, access date, exact claim supported and confidence level.
- Use official sources for campus identity and public route guides only as leads where official operator data is unavailable.

Phase 2: Stage-level verification

- Visit or contact the departure stage and the campus-side stage.
- Photograph or transcribe route boards only where permitted; avoid capturing faces or personal data unnecessarily.
- Ask the operator or stage marshal whether the route is active, its terminal, branches, operating window and intermediate stops.
- Confirm whether vehicles operate in both directions and where passengers board on the return side.
- Repeat checks at different times; a single observation is not enough to describe daily service.

Phase 3: Vehicle departure count

Count vehicles departing a defined stage during a stated observation window, for example 07:00–08:00 on a weekday. Record route board, departure time and operator identifier when visible. The result is a sample of departures in that window—not a count of the operator's fleet or all vehicles that serve the route during the day.

Research methodology: student journey and fare audit

Journey audit

- Select an origin rental cluster and a precise destination gate/building.
- Record origin stage, destination stage, walking distance, transfers and wait time.
- Record fare paid, time/date, direction, passenger category if relevant, and whether the fare was quoted or actually paid.
- Repeat for peak and off-peak periods and for the return direction.
- Where possible, collect at least three independent observations per origin–destination pair and note any disagreements.

Rental-area audit

- Record estate/settlement name, nearest stage, walking route, lighting and road crossings.
- Use current listings or direct landlord/hostel enquiries to collect rent, deposit, utilities and vacancy date.
- Do not treat a hostel directory or a review rating as proof of safety, availability or fair terms.
- For off-campus housing, verify the exact address and visit before paying; follow the university's accommodation guidance.

Night and weekend service

The final vehicle from a stage may not be the final service to a specific rental area. Record the last observed departure and ask whether the route shortens, diverts or stops early on weekends. If no return service is confirmed, label the area 'night return unverified' and do not recommend it solely on rent.

Data quality, confidence and responsible use

Confidence	Definition	Use
A — Official/observed	Official campus document or repeated dated field observation with traceable source.	Can be used in a route summary with date and citation.
B — Corroborated	Two independent sources agree, but no repeated field count is available.	Useful lead; mark remaining unknowns.
C — Single published lead	One route directory or one interview supports the claim.	Do not present as definitive current service.
D — Hypothesis	Suggested by geography or a likely corridor but not confirmed.	Use only to guide fieldwork.
U — Unknown	No adequate evidence found.	Leave blank/unknown; never infer a fare or route number.

Source hierarchy

- Official university campus/transport/accommodation notice.
- Current operator/SACCO confirmation and dated stage observation.
- Multiple independent student observations.
- Public route directory with publication/update date.
- Old blog, forum or undated map entry (lead only).

Privacy and safety

Do not publish private phone numbers, vehicle registration numbers tied to individual drivers, faces, exact home addresses of students or other personal information without a legitimate reason and permission. The public-facing dataset should focus on route and service information. Any sensitive raw field notes should be stored separately and access-controlled.

Published route lead register

This is the current starter register. The entries are route leads, not a declaration that every stage or fare remains unchanged as of the research date.

ID	Route/corridor	Route	Key stops/areas	Status
R-001	Nairobi CBD–Thika Town	237	Nairobi CBD; Pangani; Ruaraka; Roysambu; Githurai; Kahawa; KU corridor; Ruiru; Kimbo; Juja; JKUAT area; Thika	Published route guide; stage-by-stage details require confirmation
R-002	Nairobi CBD–Ruiru	145	CBD; Thika Road; Roysambu; Githurai; Kahawa; Ruiru	Published route directory; verify current stops and operator
R-003	Nairobi CBD–Ruiru/KU corridor	146	CBD; Kahawa Wendani; Kahawa Sukari; KU corridor; Ruiru	Published route directory; verify exact campus gate stop
R-004	Nairobi CBD–Githurai/Kahawa West	44	CBD/Ngara corridor; Thika Road; Githurai/Kahawa West	Published route directory; service variants possible
R-005	Nairobi CBD–Githurai	45	CBD/Ngara corridor; Thika Road; Githurai	Published route directory; confirm final destination
R-006	Nairobi CBD–Parklands/Highridge	11A	Ngara; Forest Road; Parklands; Highridge	Published route directory; not a direct Main Campus route
R-007	Nairobi CBD–Parklands	11B	Ngara; Forest Road; Parklands	Published route directory; verify current stage
R-008	Parklands–Ruaka	11F	Parklands; Limuru Road; Gigiri; Village Market; Two Rivers; Ruaka	Published route directory; route and service times to verify
R-009	Nairobi CBD–Madaraka/Strathmore	14A	CBD; Nyayo Stadium/Nairobi West corridor; Madaraka	Published route lead; exact stages and service variant to verify
R-010	Nairobi CBD–Mlolongo/Athi River	110/110A	CBD; Mombasa Road; Cabanas; Mlolongo; Athi River	Published route directory; does not prove gate-level Daystar service
R-011	Nakuru CBD/KFA–Njoro/Egerton	NK6 (directory label)	Nakuru CBD/KFA Bus Park; Njoro turnoff; Njoro; Egerton area	Secondary route directory lead; confirm current route/operator
R-012	Eldoret–Moi Main Campus	Route not confirmed	Eldoret Main Stage/Uganda Road; Kesses/Main Campus corridor	University student booklet identifies stage; route number not asserted
R-013	Eldoret–University of Eldoret Gate A	Route not confirmed	Junction; Mti Moja; Kuinet; Gate A	2025 student transport-cost assessment identifies sampled origins/CHEP SACCO; update locally
R-014	Kisumu–Maseno	Route not confirmed	Kisumu; Maseno; possible onward highway settlements	University information identifies public transport from Kisumu; exact stops need field check
R-015	Kutus–Kerugoya / Kutus–Kagio	Route not confirmed	Kutus; Kerugoya; Kagio corridor	Accommodation corridors documented; matatu route specifics need field check
R-016	Nairobi CBD–Valley Road/Daystar Nairobi	32A (route lead)	CBD; Valley Road; Hurlingham/Kilimani corridor	Secondary route lead; verify exact stop and current service

Fare handling

A public route guide may show a fare range or schedule, but fares change with distance, time, weather, traffic and operator practice. This report deliberately does not set a fixed fare for every route. Use the attached fare-audit form to record dated, stage-to-stage observations.

How to interpret route numbers and individual vehicles

A route number is a public-facing identifier, not a complete vehicle identity. One route may have multiple operators, branches, short-turn services, vehicle sizes and departure schedules. A vehicle that displays a route number may not run the full length of the route described in a guide.

Minimum route record

Field	Example/definition
Route ID	Unique local ID such as NAI-237-OUT-001; assign after verification.
Displayed route	237 — THIKA (transcribe the actual board).
Direction	Outbound from origin terminal / inbound to origin terminal.
Service variant	Full-route service, short-turn, branch, express, campus shuttle or unknown.
Observed stop sequence	List only stops actually confirmed by observation or credible operator confirmation.
Operator/SACCO	Use the public operator name; do not infer from vehicle colour.
Vehicle count	Count of departures observed in a stated window, not fleet size.
Fare record	Stage pair, actual fare, date/time and source.
Confidence	A/B/C/D/U, with note explaining the basis.

Campus profile 01: University of Nairobi (UoN) — Main Campus

Region: Nairobi CBD | Campus target: Main Campus / University Way

Research summary

Central location makes transfers across Nairobi practical; other UoN campuses require separate analysis.

Rental areas to survey

Ngara, Pangani, Nairobi CBD edges, Parklands, Nairobi West, Madaraka, South B, South C, Kilimani; select by walking route and faculty location.

Published route leads

CBD-bound city services; route 11A/11B are published leads for the Ngara–Forest Road–Parklands corridor, not direct Main Campus services.

Source register

https://metros.co.ke/nairobi-matatu-routes/ ; https://www.uonbi.ac.ke/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 01: route and stage inventory

University of Nairobi (UoN) — Main Campus

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Record exact boarding stage, alighting stop, walking route to faculty, first/last service, fare by stage and night-return options.

Campus profile 01: rental area and 50 km audit

University of Nairobi (UoN) — Main Campus

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Ngara, Pangani, Nairobi CBD edges, Parklands, Nairobi West, Madaraka, South B, South C, Kilimani; select by walking route and faculty location.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 01: field survey and vehicle departure count

University of Nairobi (UoN) — Main Campus

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 02: Kenyatta University (KU) — Main Campus

Region: Kahawa / Thika Road | Campus target: KU Main Campus, Kahawa

Research summary

The route number alone does not guarantee a gate stop or a service to the final destination.

Rental areas to survey

Kahawa Wendani, Kahawa Sukari, Githurai, Zimmerman, Roysambu, Kasarani, Mwihoko, Ruiru.

Published route leads

Published Nairobi route guide lists routes 44/45 on Githurai/Kahawa corridor, 146 towards Kahawa Sukari/KU/Ruiru, and 237 along the longer Nairobi–Thika corridor. Confirm each vehicle's exact stop.

Source register

https://metros.co.ke/nairobi-matatu-routes/ ; https://metros.co.ke/route-237-nairobi-to-thika-town-matatu-stages-stops-thika-road-guide/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 02: route and stage inventory

Kenyatta University (KU) — Main Campus

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Check campus gate, footpath, service destination board, route branch, peak fare and last vehicle after evening classes.

Campus profile 02: rental area and 50 km audit

Kenyatta University (KU) — Main Campus

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Kahawa Wendani, Kahawa Sukari, Githurai, Zimmerman, Roysambu, Kasarani, Mwihoko, Ruiru.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 02: field survey and vehicle departure count

Kenyatta University (KU) — Main Campus

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 03: JKUAT — Juja Main Campus

Region: Juja / Ruiru / Thika Road | Campus target: JKUAT Main Gate, Juja

Research summary

A Thika-bound vehicle may pass the university area but passengers should confirm the precise stop with the crew.

Rental areas to survey

Juja town, Witeithie, Kalimoni, Murera, Theta, Ruiru, Kimbo, Thika town.

Published route leads

Route 237 is a published Nairobi CBD–Thika corridor lead via Ruiru, Kimbo, Juja and JKUAT area. Some shorter services may terminate earlier.

Source register

https://metros.co.ke/route-237-nairobi-to-thika-town-matatu-stages-stops-thika-road-guide/ ; https://www.jkuat.ac.ke/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 03: route and stage inventory

JKUAT — Juja Main Campus

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Record Nairobi boarding locations, JKUAT stop name, return-side stage, fare from each rental area, and whether night return is reliable.

Campus profile 03: rental area and 50 km audit

JKUAT — Juja Main Campus

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Juja town, Witeithie, Kalimoni, Murera, Theta, Ruiru, Kimbo, Thika town.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 03: field survey and vehicle departure count

JKUAT — Juja Main Campus

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 04: Maseno University — Main Campus

Region: Maseno / Kisumu–Busia Road | Campus target: Maseno Main Campus / Siriba area

Research summary

A long-distance vehicle passing Maseno is not necessarily suitable for repeated short local trips.

Rental areas to survey

Maseno town, accommodation near Siriba and College campuses, areas along Kisumu–Busia Road, selected Kisumu neighbourhoods if commute is acceptable.

Published route leads

University information identifies public transport from Kisumu and service corridors through Maseno; a mapped Maseno matatu station and campus gate bus stop are listed in public place data.

Source register

https://www.maseno.ac.ke/ ; local stop reference: Maseno University Main Gate Bus Stop, Maseno

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 04: route and stage inventory

Maseno University — Main Campus

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Separate Kisumu–Maseno services from onward intertown services; document intermediate stops, student fares, evening availability and exact campus gate.

Campus profile 04: rental area and 50 km audit

Maseno University — Main Campus

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Maseno town, accommodation near Siriba and College campuses, areas along Kisumu–Busia Road, selected Kisumu neighbourhoods if commute is acceptable.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 04: field survey and vehicle departure count

Maseno University — Main Campus

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 05: Egerton University — Njoro Main Campus

Region: Njoro / Nakuru | Campus target: Njoro Main Campus

Research summary

Nakuru and Njoro offer different rent/commute trade-offs; current fares are not guaranteed by older listings.

Rental areas to survey

Njoro town, near campus gate, Ngata, Nakuru town, settlements along the Nakuru–Njoro road.

Published route leads

A Nakuru route directory lists NK6 CBD/KFA Bus Park–Njoro/Egerton corridor with Njoro Line SACCO as an operator lead. Verify the current route and operator.

Source register

https://www.egerton.ac.ke/ ; route directory lead: Nakuru CBD–Njoro/Egerton NK6 (verify locally)

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 05: route and stage inventory

Egerton University — Njoro Main Campus

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Log exact KFA/CBD boarding stage, turnoff, Njoro stops, campus gate drop-off, fare by stop, service hours and return frequency.

Campus profile 05: rental area and 50 km audit

Egerton University — Njoro Main Campus

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Njoro town, near campus gate, Ngata, Nakuru town, settlements along the Nakuru–Njoro road.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 05: field survey and vehicle departure count

Egerton University — Njoro Main Campus

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 06: Kirinyaga University — Kutus Campus

Region: Kutus / Kerugoya / Kirinyaga | Campus target: Kutus

Research summary

Accommodation location data can be linked to nearest verified stage, but does not prove a particular route operates there.

Rental areas to survey

Kutus town, Kerugoya, Kutus–Kagio road, Kutus–Kerugoya road, nearby settlements with reliable transport.

Published route leads

University accommodation listings identify rentals/hostels on the Kutus–Kagio corridor and within a few kilometres of campus. Specific matatu route numbers need local validation.

Source register

https://www.kyu.ac.ke/ ; official student accommodation/welfare information (check current university page)

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 06: route and stage inventory

Kirinyaga University — Kutus Campus

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Map Kutus–Kerugoya, Kutus–Kagio and wider connections; collect route board photos, SACCO, fares, first/last departures and weekend pattern.

Campus profile 06: rental area and 50 km audit

Kirinyaga University — Kutus Campus

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Kutus town, Kerugoya, Kutus–Kagio road, Kutus–Kerugoya road, nearby settlements with reliable transport.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 06: field survey and vehicle departure count

Kirinyaga University — Kutus Campus

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 07: Moi University — Main Campus

Region: Kesses / Eldoret | Campus target: Main Campus, Kesses, southeast of Eldoret

Research summary

Main Campus and Annex are different destinations and should never share a single undifferentiated route record.

Rental areas to survey

Kesses and the campus access road, Eldoret town, settlements along the Eldoret–Main Campus corridor.

Published route leads

Moi University student travel guidance identifies Eldoret Main Stage on Uganda Road for Main Campus transport; Hospital Road is identified for Annex-bound passengers.

Source register

https://mu.ac.ke/ ; 2025/26 student booklet route guidance (verify latest edition)

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 07: route and stage inventory

Moi University — Main Campus

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Confirm current terminal name, destination board, campus drop-off, fare, route frequency, return departures and distinctions from Annex services.

Campus profile 07: rental area and 50 km audit

Moi University — Main Campus

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Kesses and the campus access road, Eldoret town, settlements along the Eldoret–Main Campus corridor.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 07: field survey and vehicle departure count

Moi University — Main Campus

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 08: University of Eldoret

Region: Eldoret / campus access road | Campus target: Main Campus / Gate A

Research summary

Official university information for 2026/27 notes limited on-campus accommodation and lists approved private hostels.

Rental areas to survey

Junction, Mti Moja, Kuinet, Eldoret town and settlements on the campus corridor.

Published route leads

A 2025 student transport-cost assessment examined journeys from Junction, Mti Moja and Kuinet to Gate A using CHEP SACCO services; treat fares in the paper as historical observations.

Source register

https://uoeld.ac.ke/admissions/accredited-private-hostels-and-successful-hostel-applicants

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 08: route and stage inventory

University of Eldoret

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Re-interview students and CHEP SACCO; update fares and frequency, confirm Gate A drop-off and last departures.

Campus profile 08: rental area and 50 km audit

University of Eldoret

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Junction, Mti Moja, Kuinet, Eldoret town and settlements on the campus corridor.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 08: field survey and vehicle departure count

University of Eldoret

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 09: Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology (MMUST)

Region: Kakamega | Campus target: Main Campus, Kakamega

Research summary

Student accommodation availability may be limited; use current university accommodation notices and inspect any private hostel before payment.

Rental areas to survey

Kakamega town, nearby residential estates, campus access roads and settlements with verified local transport.

Published route leads

Kakamega local stage network and intertown services are the route discovery starting points. No route number is asserted here without current confirmation.

Source register

https://www.mmust.ac.ke/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 09: route and stage inventory

Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology (MMUST)

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Interview stage marshals/operators, record all campus-facing services, stage sequence, SACCO, return services, fares and night safety.

Campus profile 09: rental area and 50 km audit

Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology (MMUST)

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Kakamega town, nearby residential estates, campus access roads and settlements with verified local transport.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 09: field survey and vehicle departure count

Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology (MMUST)

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 10: Kisii University — Main Campus

Region: Kisii town / Kisii–Kilgoris road | Campus target: Main Campus near Kisii town

Research summary

Being near a town does not mean every route serves the university gate or returns late in the evening.

Rental areas to survey

Kisii town centre, nearby estates and settlements along the Kisii–Kilgoris road.

Published route leads

Local Kisii town stages and services along the Kisii–Kilgoris road are the starting point; route numbers and exact stops require field validation.

Source register

https://kisiiuniversity.ac.ke/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 10: route and stage inventory

Kisii University — Main Campus

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Document town-stage names, local route boards, campus-side stop, fares, first/last service, transfers and road walking distance.

Campus profile 10: rental area and 50 km audit

Kisii University — Main Campus

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Kisii town centre, nearby estates and settlements along the Kisii–Kilgoris road.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 10: field survey and vehicle departure count

Kisii University — Main Campus

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 11: Mount Kenya University (MKU) — Thika Main Campus

Region: Thika | Campus target: General Kago Road, Thika

Research summary

MKU's Thika campus is near the town centre; use the actual gate and faculty building for walking-time analysis.

Rental areas to survey

Thika CBD, nearby estates, Juja and Ruiru only where total daily commuting is practical.

Published route leads

Nairobi–Thika Route 237 is a published corridor lead; local Thika town services and walking routes need separate mapping.

Source register

https://www.mku.ac.ke/ ; https://metros.co.ke/route-237-nairobi-to-thika-town-matatu-stages-stops-thika-road-guide/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 11: route and stage inventory

Mount Kenya University (MKU) — Thika Main Campus

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Map CBD stages to General Kago Road, local connections, fares, evening frequency and any campus shuttle that is open to the student population.

Campus profile 11: rental area and 50 km audit

Mount Kenya University (MKU) — Thika Main Campus

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Thika CBD, nearby estates, Juja and Ruiru only where total daily commuting is practical.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 11: field survey and vehicle departure count

Mount Kenya University (MKU) — Thika Main Campus

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 12: USIU–Africa

Region: Thika Road / Kasarani–Roysambu | Campus target: USIU Road, off Thika Road near Exit 7

Research summary

Do not assume public matatus enter the campus or that contracted university shuttles carry non-authorised passengers.

Rental areas to survey

Kasarani, Roysambu, Garden Estate, Mirema, Zimmerman and nearby estates with a confirmed campus connection.

Published route leads

Thika Road trunk routes are candidate connections; campus-specific stop and last-mile arrangements must be confirmed. University transport is a separate service class.

Source register

https://www.usiu.ac.ke/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 12: route and stage inventory

USIU–Africa

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Record nearest legal alighting stop, walk route to campus gate, campus shuttle eligibility, service times, fare and return options.

Campus profile 12: rental area and 50 km audit

USIU–Africa

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Kasarani, Roysambu, Garden Estate, Mirema, Zimmerman and nearby estates with a confirmed campus connection.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 12: field survey and vehicle departure count

USIU–Africa

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 13: Strathmore University

Region: Madaraka / Nairobi West | Campus target: Ole Sangale Road, Madaraka

Research summary

Nearby rentals may be walkable even when their public transport connection is indirect; assess both walking and matatu options.

Rental areas to survey

Madaraka, Nairobi West, South B, South C and Lang'ata, with route-by-route verification.

Published route leads

Published Nairobi route guide lists route 14A as a CBD–Madaraka/Strathmore corridor lead.

Source register

https://www.strathmore.edu/ ; https://metros.co.ke/nairobi-matatu-routes/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 13: route and stage inventory

Strathmore University

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Confirm current 14A boarding stage and stop, additional routes, evening return availability, fare, and walking path from each rental cluster.

Campus profile 13: rental area and 50 km audit

Strathmore University

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Madaraka, Nairobi West, South B, South C and Lang'ata, with route-by-route verification.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 13: field survey and vehicle departure count

Strathmore University

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 14: Daystar University — Athi River Main Campus

Region: Athi River / Mombasa Road / Lukenya | Campus target: Athi River Main Campus, Lukenya area

Research summary

University shuttle services and ordinary public matatus are different. Do not assume a Nairobi–Athi River matatu reaches the campus gate.

Rental areas to survey

Athi River, Mlolongo, Syokimau, Greenpark, Kitengela, campus-adjacent areas.

Published route leads

Nairobi–Mombasa Road public transport is the trunk corridor; published Nairobi route guide lists route 110/110A as Mlolongo/Athi River corridor leads. Campus last mile must be verified.

Source register

https://www.daystar.ac.ke/ ; https://metros.co.ke/nairobi-matatu-routes/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 14: route and stage inventory

Daystar University — Athi River Main Campus

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Record turnoff/last-mile stage, walking distance, shuttle eligibility and schedule, fare, late return and road conditions.

Campus profile 14: rental area and 50 km audit

Daystar University — Athi River Main Campus

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Athi River, Mlolongo, Syokimau, Greenpark, Kitengela, campus-adjacent areas.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 14: field survey and vehicle departure count

Daystar University — Athi River Main Campus

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 15: KCA University

Region: Ruaraka / Thika Road | Campus target: Main campus, Ruaraka area

Research summary

Route maps may name KCA as an intermediate stop without establishing which campus entrance or pedestrian gate is accessible.

Rental areas to survey

Ruaraka, Kasarani, Roysambu, Zimmerman and nearby Thika Road estates.

Published route leads

Nairobi CBD–Ruaraka and Thika Road routes are candidates; current gate-specific stop and operator should be confirmed.

Source register

https://www.kca.ac.ke/ ; https://metros.co.ke/nairobi-matatu-routes/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 15: route and stage inventory

KCA University

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Record campus gate, legal drop-off point, route number/destination, transfer needs, fare, first/last service.

Campus profile 15: rental area and 50 km audit

KCA University

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Ruaraka, Kasarani, Roysambu, Zimmerman and nearby Thika Road estates.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 15: field survey and vehicle departure count

KCA University

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 16: Zetech University — Ruiru Main Campus

Region: Ruiru / Thika Road | Campus target: Ruiru Main Campus (verify current campus address)

Research summary

Zetech has multiple locations; route planning must specify the campus, not just the institution.

Rental areas to survey

Ruiru, Kimbo, Kahawa, Githurai and other settlements with a direct service or reasonable transfer.

Published route leads

Ruiru-bound services on Thika Road are candidate corridors; verify the current campus-specific last mile.

Source register

https://www.zetech.ac.ke/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 16: route and stage inventory

Zetech University — Ruiru Main Campus

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Confirm campus address and gate first, then record Ruiru stage, walking route, fare and evening service.

Campus profile 16: rental area and 50 km audit

Zetech University — Ruiru Main Campus

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Ruiru, Kimbo, Kahawa, Githurai and other settlements with a direct service or reasonable transfer.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 16: field survey and vehicle departure count

Zetech University — Ruiru Main Campus

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 17: Technical University of Kenya (TUK)

Region: Nairobi CBD | Campus target: Haile Selassie Avenue / CBD

Research summary

The exact faculty building and class timetable affect whether a route is useful.

Rental areas to survey

Ngara, Nairobi CBD edges, Pangani, Nairobi West, South B, South C and other connected urban estates.

Published route leads

Central Nairobi routes with CBD access; nearby stage and pedestrian approach are more important than long-distance route numbers.

Source register

https://www.tukenya.ac.ke/ ; https://metros.co.ke/nairobi-matatu-routes/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 17: route and stage inventory

Technical University of Kenya (TUK)

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

List routes passing the closest safe alighting points, transfers, fares, late classes and walking time to the gate.

Campus profile 17: rental area and 50 km audit

Technical University of Kenya (TUK)

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Ngara, Nairobi CBD edges, Pangani, Nairobi West, South B, South C and other connected urban estates.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 17: field survey and vehicle departure count

Technical University of Kenya (TUK)

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 18: Dedan Kimathi University of Technology

Region: Nyeri | Campus target: Main Campus, Nyeri area

Research summary

Do not infer that intercounty vehicles to Nyeri provide a daily student service to the university gate.

Rental areas to survey

Nyeri town, campus-adjacent rentals, settlements along the campus access road.

Published route leads

Nyeri town matatu stages and campus-access services; route numbers and campus shuttle operations require current confirmation.

Source register

https://www.dkut.ac.ke/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 18: route and stage inventory

Dedan Kimathi University of Technology

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Record Nyeri termini, local campus route, last-mile walk, fare by stop, first/last vehicle and weekend operation.

Campus profile 18: rental area and 50 km audit

Dedan Kimathi University of Technology

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Nyeri town, campus-adjacent rentals, settlements along the campus access road.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 18: field survey and vehicle departure count

Dedan Kimathi University of Technology

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 19: Chuka University

Region: Chuka / Tharaka Nithi | Campus target: Main Campus, Chuka

Research summary

The road corridor and service frequency should be measured directly before recommending farther towns.

Rental areas to survey

Chuka town, campus-adjacent rentals and nearby settlements on the access roads.

Published route leads

Chuka town stages and intertown routes serving the university area are the discovery starting points; exact operator and route numbers need field verification.

Source register

https://www.chuka.ac.ke/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 19: route and stage inventory

Chuka University

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Record Nairobi/Meru/Embu connections where relevant, Chuka stage, local campus transfer, fares, return frequency and last service.

Campus profile 19: rental area and 50 km audit

Chuka University

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Chuka town, campus-adjacent rentals and nearby settlements on the access roads.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 19: field survey and vehicle departure count

Chuka University

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 20: Machakos University

Region: Machakos town | Campus target: Machakos University campus

Research summary

Intertown services to Machakos town may require a separate local stage or walk to campus.

Rental areas to survey

Machakos town, campus-adjacent estates, Mumbuni and other nearby areas with a confirmed stage connection.

Published route leads

Machakos town local stages and Nairobi–Machakos intertown services are candidate connections; no unverified route number is asserted.

Source register

https://www.mksu.ac.ke/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 20: route and stage inventory

Machakos University

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Record Nairobi termini, Machakos arrival stage, local campus-facing services, fare, journey time, night return and weekend patterns.

Campus profile 20: rental area and 50 km audit

Machakos University

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Machakos town, campus-adjacent estates, Mumbuni and other nearby areas with a confirmed stage connection.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 20: field survey and vehicle departure count

Machakos University

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 21: South Eastern Kenya University (SEKU)

Region: Kwa Vonza / Kitui | Campus target: Main Campus, Kwa Vonza area

Research summary

A town within 50 km by road may still be a poor daily option if return vehicles are infrequent.

Rental areas to survey

Kwa Vonza, Kitui town and campus-adjacent settlements; farther origins only if service frequency is verified.

Published route leads

Kitui and Kwa Vonza local transport corridors are starting points; route numbers, stops and service frequency require on-site verification.

Source register

https://www.seku.ac.ke/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 21: route and stage inventory

South Eastern Kenya University (SEKU)

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Confirm Kitui/Kwa Vonza termini, exact campus stop, fare, first/last service, weekend frequency and emergency return alternatives.

Campus profile 21: rental area and 50 km audit

South Eastern Kenya University (SEKU)

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Kwa Vonza, Kitui town and campus-adjacent settlements; farther origins only if service frequency is verified.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 21: field survey and vehicle departure count

South Eastern Kenya University (SEKU)

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 22: University of Embu

Region: Embu town / Njukiri | Campus target: Main Campus, Njukiri area

Research summary

A stage near the university is not proof of a direct vehicle from every rental area.

Rental areas to survey

Embu town, Njukiri and settlements along the campus access road.

Published route leads

Embu town local services and intertown stages are the starting points; campus-specific route number must be verified.

Source register

https://www.embuni.ac.ke/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 22: route and stage inventory

University of Embu

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Record Embu terminus, campus-side stage, route destination board, fare, walking distance, first/last service and weekend operation.

Campus profile 22: rental area and 50 km audit

University of Embu

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Embu town, Njukiri and settlements along the campus access road.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 22: field survey and vehicle departure count

University of Embu

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

Campus profile 23: Pwani University

Region: Kilifi | Campus target: Kilifi campus

Research summary

Long-distance vehicles may serve a highway stop rather than the campus gate.

Rental areas to survey

Kilifi town, campus-adjacent neighbourhoods and settlements along the Kilifi–Mombasa/Malindi corridors.

Published route leads

Kilifi town matatu stages and intertown services are the discovery starting points; local campus access and route numbers need confirmation.

Source register

https://www.pu.ac.ke/

Evidence rule

Keep published claims separate from current field observations. Record access date and exact supporting page or interview. If a route is not confirmed, retain the status 'field verification required'.

Campus profile 23: route and stage inventory

Pwani University

Complete one row per distinct route variant and direction. If one route has a full-length and short-turn service, record them separately.

Field	Record 1	Record 2	Record 3
Route ID			
Displayed route number/name			
Operator/SACCO			
Origin terminal			
Destination terminal			
Direction / variant			
Boarding stage(s)			
Campus-side stage/gate			
Intermediate stops (observed)			
Transfer required?			
First observed departure			
Last observed departure			
Observation date/time			
Source/confidence			

Campus-specific verification focus

Record town stages, local campus route, last-mile walk, fares, first/last departures and evening return.

Campus profile 23: rental area and 50 km audit

Pwani University

Record road distance from the exact campus gate. Do not use straight-line distance as a substitute for driving/commuting distance. Areas outside the 50 km road radius may be retained as comparison options.

Rental cluster / town	Nearest verified stage	Road km to gate	Walk minutes to stage	Transfers	Fare one way	Return after evening?	Status/source

Rental-area candidates

Kilifi town, campus-adjacent neighbourhoods and settlements along the Kilifi–Mombasa/Malindi corridors.

Decision rule

Do not rank a rental area as convenient until both outbound and return service are confirmed. Compare rent + fare + transfers + walking time + safety and reliability, rather than rent alone.

Campus profile 23: field survey and vehicle departure count

Pwani University

Observation session metadata

Field	Value
Observer initials / team ID	
Date and day of week	
Stage / GPS or map pin	
Start and end time	
Weather / unusual conditions	
Direction observed	
Route(s) included	
Count method / limitations	

Departure log — one row per vehicle departure observed

Time	Route board	Operator/SACCO	Destination shown	Full/short-turn?	Passenger load (rough)	Notes

Count result: ____ departures in ____ minutes. This is a sample for this stage, date and time only; it is not the operator's total fleet.

50 km radius method and corridor segmentation

- Choose one precise campus gate as the origin. For a multi-campus institution, create a separate origin record for each campus.
- Use road-network distance for the operational 50 km radius. Store straight-line distance separately if available.
- Create rings for fieldwork prioritisation: 0–5 km, 5–10 km, 10–20 km, 20–35 km and 35–50 km by road.
- Include settlements outside the radius only in a separate 'beyond-radius comparison' section.
- Do not claim a place is a practical daily commute until a usable outbound and return service has been confirmed.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Fare audit protocol

- Record fare as quoted or paid; never merge the two.
- Record origin and destination stages, date, clock time, weekday/weekend, weather and direction.
- Collect multiple observations where possible. Keep the minimum, typical and maximum observed values separate.
- If an operator quotes a peak surcharge, record the condition and time window rather than treating it as universal.
- Update fare records after major public transport changes and clearly label stale observations.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Vehicle departure count protocol

- Define the stage, direction, time window and route before counting.
- Count departures, not unique vehicles, unless the study explicitly identifies unique vehicles using an approved method.
- Do not extrapolate a one-hour count to a daily fleet size without a justified sampling design.
- If a vehicle leaves the stage and returns during the same window, decide in advance whether the metric is departures or unique identifiable vehicles.
- Record disruptions, road closures, rain, strikes, university holidays and exam periods.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Student journey diary

- Ask participants to record origin, destination, departure time, arrival time, transfers, fares and unexpected waits.
- Use participant codes rather than full names.
- Collect journeys from different class schedules and housing areas.
- Include return journeys, because one-way route convenience can conceal poor evening availability.
- Report sample size and dates; do not generalise a few diaries to all students.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Rental cost and access audit

- Record monthly rent, deposit, water, electricity, internet, cooking arrangements and other mandatory charges separately.
- Record walking distance to the nearest verified stage and the exact campus gate.
- Check whether the route operates during the student's actual first class and last class times.
- Record current vacancy status and date contacted; listings can become stale quickly.
- Inspect the accommodation and verify the landlord/hostel operator before payment.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Last-mile audit

- Record the exact point where the public matatu stops and the path to the gate.
- Measure walking time in daylight and note whether the route has sidewalks, crossings, lighting and busy-road exposure.
- Record whether a local boda, tuk-tuk, shuttle or second matatu is needed; list costs separately.
- Do not assume a university shuttle accepts all passengers; verify eligibility and schedule.
- If last-mile arrangements change by time of day, create separate records.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Operator interview guide

- What is the displayed route name and final destination?
- Which stops are served on the outbound and return directions?
- Does the vehicle run the full route or turn around early at certain times?
- What are the first and last departure windows on weekdays, weekends and holidays?
- What are current fares between the specified stages, and under what conditions do they change?
- Which SACCO or operator manages the service, and how can the route information be checked again?

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Campus transport office interview guide

- What is the exact campus gate/address students should use for route planning?
- Does the university operate a shuttle or contracted service, and who is eligible to use it?
- What are the current shuttle routes, pick-up points, hours and charges, if any?
- Which approved hostels or accommodation notices are current?
- Are there safety or access restrictions affecting campus-side drop-off points?
- How should students verify official updates?

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Data cleaning rules

- Use one standard spelling for each stage and preserve local aliases in a separate field.
- Do not combine different campuses or route variants just because they share a university name.
- Use ISO dates (YYYY-MM-DD) and 24-hour time (HH:MM).
- Store fare currency as KES and store numeric fare separately from notes.
- Use blank/unknown for missing values; do not substitute zero.
- Keep source URL and source date for each non-field fact.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Route status and confidence rules

- Proposed: suggested from geography only.
- Published lead: appears in a public route guide.
- Operator-confirmed: current operator/stage source confirms route details.
- Field-observed: observed on a dated visit.
- Corroborated: multiple independent sources agree.
- Inactive/retired: only use when current evidence establishes that the route is no longer operating.
- Unresolved: sources conflict or no current confirmation is available.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Campus-specific return-trip check

- Start from the campus gate or nearest safe public stop at the student's actual departure time.
- Record whether the route serves the desired rental area directly or requires a transfer.
- Ask whether the last vehicle is full-route or a short-turn service.
- Record what happens after the last observed vehicle: verified alternative, unverified, or no known option.
- Repeat during exam periods or weekends if the university calendar changes demand.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Evidence log and change tracking

- Every route claim should have a source ID and a date last checked.
- When an operator changes stage or route, keep the old record with an end date rather than deleting history.
- Record who supplied the information by role, not necessarily by personal name.
- Attach permitted photos or public notice references to the source register.
- Review route leads at least once per academic term and after major road or city traffic changes.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

How to compare rental options fairly

- Estimate monthly transport cost as round-trip fare × actual campus days, plus transfers and last-mile transport.
- Add rent, utilities, deposits amortised over the expected stay and unavoidable service charges.
- Compare commute time in both directions and include waiting time.
- Record the latest reliable return service and alternative arrangements.
- A lower rent is not automatically a better choice if transport is expensive or unreliable.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Sample route ID convention

- Use region-campus-route-direction-sequence, such as NAI-UON-237-IN-001.
- Keep route ID separate from the public route number; the latter can be reused or displayed inconsistently.
- Create separate IDs for outbound and inbound service if the stops differ.
- Create a separate service variant for short-turn, express or campus shuttle.
- Do not encode a vehicle registration number into the public route ID.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Research limitations and next steps

- This report is a desk-research starter plus fieldwork workbook, not a complete census.
- The public route directory is strongest for selected Nairobi corridors; regional campuses have more route details marked for field verification.
- Fares, stages, route branches and service times are dynamic.
- The next highest-value work is a dated stage census, operator interviews and student journey survey.
- Publish a refreshed version with field-observed data only after sample design and quality checks are complete.

Record your findings in the copyable CSV and the blank field forms. Keep each observation traceable to a date, stage and source.

Source register

The URLs below are starting points for verification. A source link does not mean every statement in this report is proven by that page; the source note identifies the intended use.

ID	Source	Use	URL	Caveat
S-001	Metros Kenya — Nairobi Matatu Routes	Public route directory; route leads for 145/146/237, Parklands, Mombasa Road and other corridors	https://metros.co.ke/nairobi-matatu-routes/	Secondary route guide; verify current operations.
S-002	Metros Kenya — Route 237 Nairobi to Thika	Route 237 corridor description and major areas	https://metros.co.ke/route-237-nairobi-to-thika-town-matatu-stages-stops-thika-road-guide/	Published 10 Aug 2025; confirm on the ground.
S-003	University of Eldoret — accredited private hostels 2026/27	Current accommodation notice and warnings to pre-visit before paying	https://uoeld.ac.ke/admissions/accredited-private-hostels-and-successful-hostel-applicants	Official university page; re-check for updates.
S-004	Moi University	Official university source; campus-specific travel instructions should be checked against latest student booklet	https://mu.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-005	Maseno University	Official campus and student information	https://www.maseno.ac.ke/	Official source; verify current page.
S-006	Egerton University	Official campus information	https://www.egerton.ac.ke/	Official source; route NK6 is a secondary lead requiring validation.
S-007	Kirinyaga University	Official university information	https://www.kyu.ac.ke/	Official source; exact rental list and local routes require current check.
S-008	JKUAT	Official campus information	https://www.jkuat.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-009	University of Nairobi	Official campus information	https://www.uonbi.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-010	Kenyatta University	Official campus information	https://www.ku.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-011	Mount Kenya University	Official campus information	https://www.mku.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-012	USIU–Africa	Official campus and transport information	https://www.usiu.ac.ke/	Official source; verify public/private shuttle eligibility.
S-013	Strathmore University	Official campus information	https://www.strathmore.edu/	Official source.
S-014	Daystar University	Official campus information	https://www.daystar.ac.ke/	Official source; distinguish Athi River and Nairobi campuses.
S-015	KCA University	Official campus information	https://www.kca.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-016	Zetech University	Official campus information	https://www.zetech.ac.ke/	Official source; campus address must be specified.
S-017	Technical University of Kenya	Official campus information	https://www.tukenya.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-018	Dedan Kimathi University of Technology	Official campus information	https://www.dkut.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-019	Chuka University	Official campus information	https://www.chuka.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-020	Machakos University	Official campus information	https://www.mksu.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-021	South Eastern Kenya University	Official campus information	https://www.seku.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-022	University of Embu	Official campus information	https://www.embuni.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-023	Pwani University	Official campus information	https://www.pu.ac.ke/	Official source.
S-024	Kisii University	Official campus information	https://kisiiuniversity.ac.ke/	Official source.

Blank form A — Route register

Copy these column headings into a spreadsheet or CSV. Add rows only for observations you can trace to a source.

Route ID	University/ca

Quality rule: blank means unknown; use a dated note rather than guessing.

Blank form B — Stage sequence

Copy these column headings into a spreadsheet or CSV. Add rows only for observations you can trace to a source.

Route ID	Stop order

Quality rule: blank means unknown; use a dated note rather than guessing.

Blank form C — Fare audit

Copy these column headings into a spreadsheet or CSV. Add rows only for observations you can trace to a source.

Date	Campus

Quality rule: blank means unknown; use a dated note rather than guessing.

Blank form D — Vehicle departure count

Copy these column headings into a spreadsheet or CSV. Add rows only for observations you can trace to a source.

Date	Stage

Quality rule: blank means unknown; use a dated note rather than guessing.

Blank form E — Rental area

Copy these column headings into a spreadsheet or CSV. Add rows only for observations you can trace to a source.

Campus	Rental cluste

Quality rule: blank means unknown; use a dated note rather than guessing.

Blank form F — Campus shuttle

Copy these column headings into a spreadsheet or CSV. Add rows only for observations you can trace to a source.

Campus	Operator

Quality rule: blank means unknown; use a dated note rather than guessing.

Blank form G — Student journey diary

Copy these column headings into a spreadsheet or CSV. Add rows only for observations you can trace to a source.

Participant code	Date

Quality rule: blank means unknown; use a dated note rather than guessing.

Blank form H — Operator interview

Copy these column headings into a spreadsheet or CSV. Add rows only for observations you can trace to a source.

Interview ID	Date

Quality rule: blank means unknown; use a dated note rather than guessing.

Blank form I — Source log

Copy these column headings into a spreadsheet or CSV. Add rows only for observations you can trace to a source.

Source ID	Claim suppor

Quality rule: blank means unknown; use a dated note rather than guessing.

Blank form J — 50 km place audit

Copy these column headings into a spreadsheet or CSV. Add rows only for observations you can trace to a source.

Campus gate	Town/settlem

Quality rule: blank means unknown; use a dated note rather than guessing.

Repeatable fieldwork worksheet 01

Use this page for an additional route, stage, rental cluster or repeat observation session. Copy the row into the CSV dataset after quality review.

Field	Value
Campus/institution	
Route/stage ID	
Date / day	
Observation window	
Origin / direction	
Route board and destination	
Operator/SACCO	
Stops confirmed	
Departures counted	
Fare observed (KES)	
Rental area connected	
Road distance to campus	
Return service / last departure	
Source / confidence	
Unresolved questions	

Do not convert a short observation into a daily fleet estimate. Preserve date, time, direction and source for every claim.

Repeatable fieldwork worksheet 02

Use this page for an additional route, stage, rental cluster or repeat observation session. Copy the row into the CSV dataset after quality review.

Field	Value
Campus/institution	
Route/stage ID	
Date / day	
Observation window	
Origin / direction	
Route board and destination	
Operator/SACCO	
Stops confirmed	
Departures counted	
Fare observed (KES)	
Rental area connected	
Road distance to campus	
Return service / last departure	
Source / confidence	
Unresolved questions	

Do not convert a short observation into a daily fleet estimate. Preserve date, time, direction and source for every claim.

Repeatable fieldwork worksheet 03

Use this page for an additional route, stage, rental cluster or repeat observation session. Copy the row into the CSV dataset after quality review.

Field	Value
Campus/institution	
Route/stage ID	
Date / day	
Observation window	
Origin / direction	
Route board and destination	
Operator/SACCO	
Stops confirmed	
Departures counted	
Fare observed (KES)	
Rental area connected	
Road distance to campus	
Return service / last departure	
Source / confidence	
Unresolved questions	

Do not convert a short observation into a daily fleet estimate. Preserve date, time, direction and source for every claim.

Repeatable fieldwork worksheet 04

Use this page for an additional route, stage, rental cluster or repeat observation session. Copy the row into the CSV dataset after quality review.

Field	Value
Campus/institution	
Route/stage ID	
Date / day	
Observation window	
Origin / direction	
Route board and destination	
Operator/SACCO	
Stops confirmed	
Departures counted	
Fare observed (KES)	
Rental area connected	
Road distance to campus	
Return service / last departure	
Source / confidence	
Unresolved questions	

Do not convert a short observation into a daily fleet estimate. Preserve date, time, direction and source for every claim.

Repeatable fieldwork worksheet 05

Use this page for an additional route, stage, rental cluster or repeat observation session. Copy the row into the CSV dataset after quality review.

Field	Value
Campus/institution	
Route/stage ID	
Date / day	
Observation window	
Origin / direction	
Route board and destination	
Operator/SACCO	
Stops confirmed	
Departures counted	
Fare observed (KES)	
Rental area connected	
Road distance to campus	
Return service / last departure	
Source / confidence	
Unresolved questions	

Do not convert a short observation into a daily fleet estimate. Preserve date, time, direction and source for every claim.

Repeatable fieldwork worksheet 06

Use this page for an additional route, stage, rental cluster or repeat observation session. Copy the row into the CSV dataset after quality review.

Field	Value
Campus/institution	
Route/stage ID	
Date / day	
Observation window	
Origin / direction	
Route board and destination	
Operator/SACCO	
Stops confirmed	
Departures counted	
Fare observed (KES)	
Rental area connected	
Road distance to campus	
Return service / last departure	
Source / confidence	
Unresolved questions	

Do not convert a short observation into a daily fleet estimate. Preserve date, time, direction and source for every claim.

Repeatable fieldwork worksheet 07

Use this page for an additional route, stage, rental cluster or repeat observation session. Copy the row into the CSV dataset after quality review.

Field	Value
Campus/institution	
Route/stage ID	
Date / day	
Observation window	
Origin / direction	
Route board and destination	
Operator/SACCO	
Stops confirmed	
Departures counted	
Fare observed (KES)	
Rental area connected	
Road distance to campus	
Return service / last departure	
Source / confidence	
Unresolved questions	

Do not convert a short observation into a daily fleet estimate. Preserve date, time, direction and source for every claim.

Repeatable fieldwork worksheet 08

Use this page for an additional route, stage, rental cluster or repeat observation session. Copy the row into the CSV dataset after quality review.

Field	Value
Campus/institution	
Route/stage ID	
Date / day	
Observation window	
Origin / direction	
Route board and destination	
Operator/SACCO	
Stops confirmed	
Departures counted	
Fare observed (KES)	
Rental area connected	
Road distance to campus	
Return service / last departure	
Source / confidence	
Unresolved questions	

Do not convert a short observation into a daily fleet estimate. Preserve date, time, direction and source for every claim.

Repeatable fieldwork worksheet 09

Use this page for an additional route, stage, rental cluster or repeat observation session. Copy the row into the CSV dataset after quality review.

Field	Value
Campus/institution	
Route/stage ID	
Date / day	
Observation window	
Origin / direction	
Route board and destination	
Operator/SACCO	
Stops confirmed	
Departures counted	
Fare observed (KES)	
Rental area connected	
Road distance to campus	
Return service / last departure	
Source / confidence	
Unresolved questions	

Do not convert a short observation into a daily fleet estimate. Preserve date, time, direction and source for every claim.

Repeatable fieldwork worksheet 10

Use this page for an additional route, stage, rental cluster or repeat observation session. Copy the row into the CSV dataset after quality review.

Field	Value
Campus/institution	
Route/stage ID	
Date / day	
Observation window	
Origin / direction	
Route board and destination	
Operator/SACCO	
Stops confirmed	
Departures counted	
Fare observed (KES)	
Rental area connected	
Road distance to campus	
Return service / last departure	
Source / confidence	
Unresolved questions	

Do not convert a short observation into a daily fleet estimate. Preserve date, time, direction and source for every claim.

Final checklist before publishing a verified route atlas

- Every campus record identifies a specific campus gate or building.
- Every route record has an observed/reported status, direction and last-checked date.
- Every fare is tied to a stage pair, date, time and source.
- Every vehicle count specifies a stage and observation window.
- Every rental cluster has a nearest verified stage and return-service assessment.
- The 50 km boundary is calculated by road distance and clearly marked.
- Campus shuttle information is separated from public matatu services.
- Route branches, short-turn services and campus variants are separate records.
- Sources and conflicting observations are retained rather than erased.
- No unsupported total fleet count or fixed fare is presented as fact.

Recommended final deliverable after fieldwork

Publish a verified route atlas, searchable CSV/spreadsheet, map of campus-to-rental corridors, fare comparison table, and a date-stamped source register. This current report is the desk-research baseline and data-collection workbook for that later release.

End of report